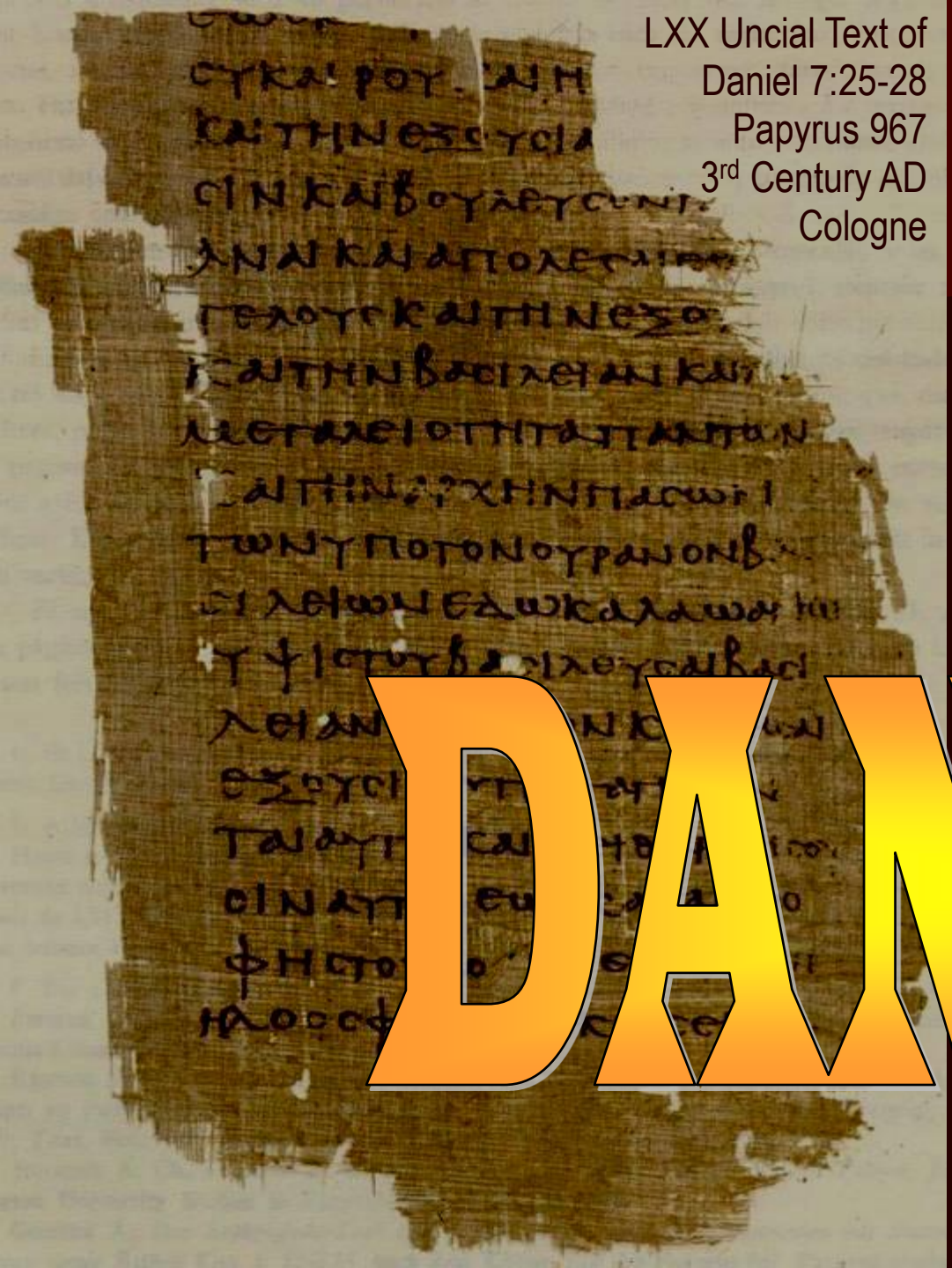

LXX Uncial Text of
Daniel 7:25-28
Papyrus 967
3rd Century AD
Cologne

Book of DANIEL

Daniel in Context

The Big Picture

Defining Symbols

controlling Ideas that made Judah's culture unique

Torah

The covenant binding Yahweh and Israel

Zion Temple

Yahweh's dwellingplace forever

Land of Israel

Promised on oath to Abraham's descendants

Davidic King

The dynasty whose line of kings would never end

How might the exile have affected the people's understanding of these symbols?

- Torah
- Land
- Temple
- King

How did the prophets relate to these symbols?

DEUTERONOMIC *...relating to the Book of Deuteronomy and its covenant code*

Old Testament scholars frequently say that all the prophets were Deuteronomic.

- **What might this mean?**

The Prophetic Anticipation of Exile

8th Century

Therefore, I will send you into exile beyond Damascus (Am. 5:27).

The Israelites will live many days without king or prince… (Ho. 3:4).

Only a remnant will return (Is. 1:22).

Zion will be plowed like a field (Mic. 3:12).

7th Century

I will stretch out my hand against Judah and against all who live in Jerusalem… Be silent…for the Day of Yahweh is near. (Zep. 1:4a, 7a)

This whole country…will serve the king of Babylon 70 years (Je. 25:11).

6th Century

I am about to desecrate my sanctuary (Eze. 24:21).

The Eschatological Language of the Prophets

יוֹם יְהוָה (= Day of Yahweh)

בְּאַחֲרִית הַיָּמִים (= in days to come, in the last days)

בְּיוֹם הַהוּא (= in that day)

All these expressions are fluid and have a semantic range that includes the near future as well as the indeterminate future.

Day of Yahweh

NEAR FUTURE

- *Judgment by exile on the unfaithful nations of Israel and Judah*
- *Judgments in history on the nations surrounding Israel and Judah*

FAR FUTURE

- *Judgment on a blasphemous world by universal cataclysm*
- *Disintegration of the universe*
- *Salvation of God's people*
- *Victory of God's armies*
- *Universal peace*

EXILE OF THE SOUTH

Judah

- Deportation and release of Manasseh by Ashurbanipal of Assyria (ca. 648 BC)
- Vassalship of Jehoiakim to Pharaoh Neco of Egypt (609-605 BC)
- Vassalship of Jehoiakim to Nebuchadnezzar of Babylon (605-598 BC)

  Included the deportation of Daniel & the Three Young Men
- Rebellion and execution of Jehoiakim by Nebuchadnezzar of Babylon (598 BC)
- Deportation of Jehoiachin by Nebuchadnezzar (598-597 BC, called "the 1st Deportation")

  Included the deportation of Ezekiel
- Destruction of Jerusalem under Zedekiah and deportation by Nebuchadnezzar (587-586 BC, called "the 2nd Deportation")
- Final deportation (582 BC, cf. Je. 52:28-30)

Basic Conclusions of the Prophets

The kingdoms of Israel and Judah were not the kingdom of God.

Covenant failure by the Israelites did not equal covenant failure by God.

Judgment by exile was not Yahweh's final word.

The Prophets' Vision of the Last Days

- Judgment of the nations
- Salvation of God's people
- Union of Israel and Judah
- Regathering of the exiles
- Remnant to be saved
- Gentiles to join the commonwealth of Israel
- Gift of the Spirit to be poured out
- Coming of the Royal Figure (Messiah)
- Coming of the Suffering Servant
- The New Covenant
- Jerusalem to be the capital of the world